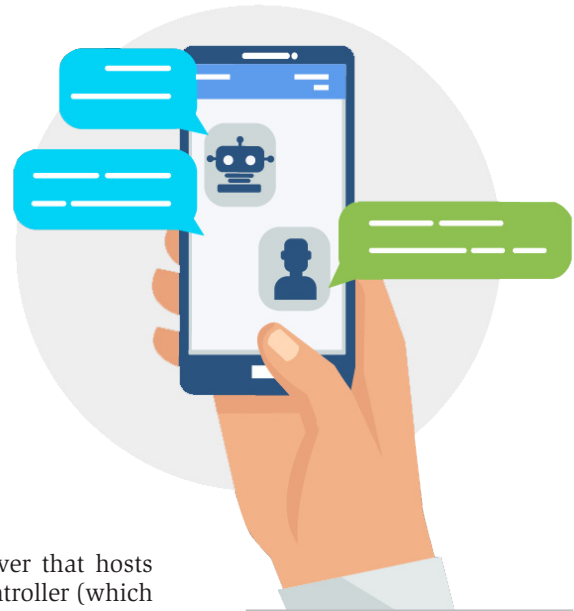


Creating A Very Basic Chatbot In Python On Telegram Messenger

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The Internet is full of articles about building chatbots on platforms like Telegram. However, in this article, readers get some insights on how to code for a chatbot in Python. Understanding the package used in this article will enable the adventurous to extend the functionality of this chatbot on their own



To get started with building the chatbot in real-time, there are some prerequisites, which are as follows:

- Basic knowledge of Python and using Pip/Conda to install packages.
- A Python IDE (I use Jupyter Notebook, while you could pick any of the popular options like Spyder, PyCharm, Visual Studio Code, or Eclipse (with PyDev)).
- You need to install Telegram on a mobile phone and also on your desktop.
- You will need the Python library *python-telegram-bot*.

How the bot scheme works

You need to understand that there are three actors in the scheme—the bot

user, the Telegram server that hosts the bot, and the bot controller (which is from the Python script that we write and execute).

Also, note that you can use the following two ways to control the bot:

The ‘polling’ scheme. Here the Python script (which controls the bot) will periodically access, i.e., ‘poll’ the bot on the Telegram server, check if there are any new messages from a bot user, and respond accordingly.

The webhook scheme. This is the more efficient scheme. Here the bot

controller script does not ‘poll’ the bot; rather, it is the bot that informs the bot controller that a new message has been sent by a bot user. This scheme, however, requires two additional things—a permanent IP address of the server where the bot controller is located, and that the server hosting the bot controller must be HTTPS

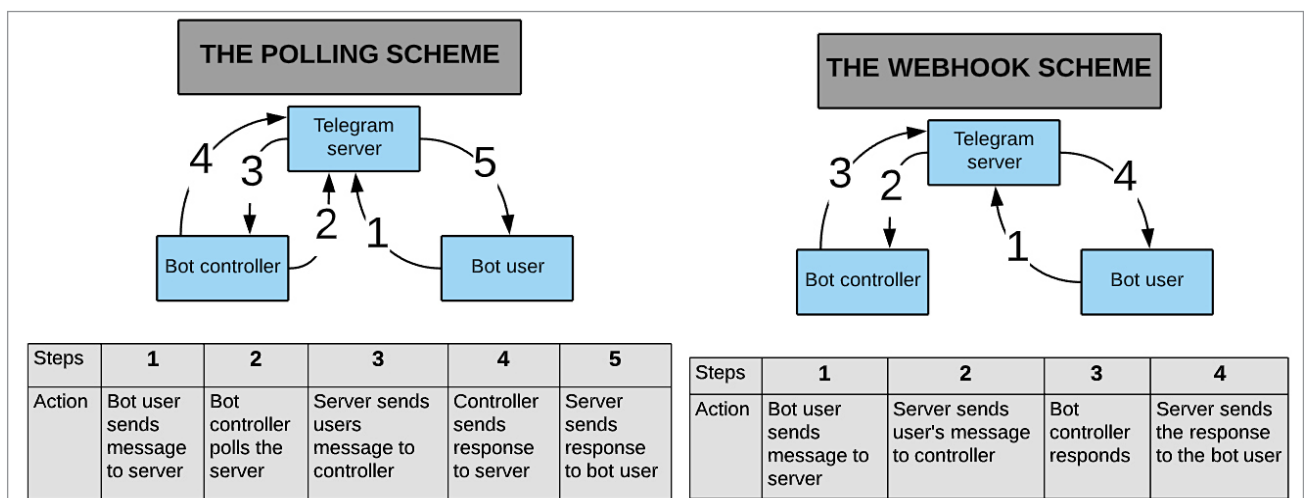


Fig. 1: The two different schemes for working the bot